Final Approach

The design system for a top-down air traffic game that looks like a box of toys tipped onto a lawn.

FOUNDATIONS

Principles

1

Outline everything

Every drawn shape carries a thick outline stroke with round joins. No hairlines, no shape without an edge.

2

Flat and bright

Fills are single flat colours. No gradients or textures. Only things that fly get a soft shadow.

3

Toy scale

Sizes are exaggerated, not realistic. A jumbo is nearly twice a light prop.

4

Silhouette before colour

Types, zones and states are told apart by shape first. Colour confirms.

5

The field stays clear

UI lives in small outlined chips at the edges. Nothing covers a landing zone.

FOUNDATIONS

Colour

59 colour tokens in two themes. The world is lawn, asphalt and white aircraft; the UI lives in the sky; sun yellow is the signature. Swatches follow the theme switch; values list Day first.

Ink and edges

outline
#1d2545
night #0a0e24
The thick cartoon outline on every drawn shape: aircraft, runways, buttons, panels, HUD chips. Never pure black. Also the colour of hard lip shadows.

ink
#1d2545
Primary text and icons on surface, surface-raised and surface-sunken. The same in both themes: panels stay paper-light at night.

ink-muted
#4f5a7c
Secondary text, captions and hints on surface, surface-raised and surface-sunken.

on-accent
#1d2545
Text and icons on any bright fill: sun, tangerine, cherry, success, sky-500, star and every path colour. Dark in both themes because the fills stay bright.

on-outline
#fffaf0
Text and icons on an outline-coloured fill: coach marks, tooltips, the callsign tag.

on-sky
#1d2545
night #f6f2e4
Text and icons placed straight on bg-sky, sky-100 or sky-300, outside any panel: menu titles, version line.

on-sky-muted
#2f3b63
night #b5bfdd
Secondary text straight on bg-sky, sky-100 or sky-300.

Sky and surfaces

bg-sky
#8fd3fb
night #151c40
Background of menus and every non-gameplay screen. The sky the UI lives in.

sky-100
#e6f6ff
night #1c2654
Quietest backdrop tint on bg-sky: far cloud bank, sunburst rays on menus. Text on it is on-sky.

sky-300
#a9defc
night #2b3a82
Backdrop stripes and near cloud bank on bg-sky. Text on it is on-sky.

sky-500
#4db8f5
night #5aa8f0
Secondary button fill, info status, active toggle track. Text on it is on-accent.

sky-700
#1668ad
Links and emphasised text on surface and surface-raised; lip under sky-500 fills.

surface
#fffaf0
night #efe9d8
Panels, dialogs, level cards and HUD chips. Paper-light in both themes so the outline always reads.

surface-raised
#ffffff
night #fffaf0
A surface sitting on a surface: toggle knobs, the selected segment, score popups.

surface-sunken
#e2eefa
night #cfd6ea
Wells and tracks: toggle track, segmented control trough, empty life slots, locked level art.

Airfield

bg-field
= grass-500
Background of the gameplay viewport: the airfield lawn.

grass-300
#b4e36a
night #5aa57c
Light mowing stripe and grass tufts on the field.

grass-500
#7fcf4b
night #3f8a66
Base lawn colour of the airfield.

grass-700
#5cb337
night #327559
Dark mowing stripe, taxiway verge, bushes.

grass-900
#3b8a2a
night #1f5443
Hedge and tree shade; grass detail next to asphalt.

asphalt-300
#939cb0
night #7a84a6
Runway shoulder and apron wear.



asphalt-500

#6a7389

night #5e6788

Runway, taxiway and helipad surface.



asphalt-700

#474f63

night #454d6b

Tyre marks and the touchdown zone on the runway.



marking

#ffffff

night #eef2fb

Runway centre line, threshold bars, numbers and the helipad H, on asphalt-500 and asphalt-700.



marking-warn

#ffd23f

Helipad ring and hold-short lines, on asphalt-500 and asphalt-700.

Accents



sun

#ffcb3d

Primary button fill, score, warning status. The game's signature yellow. Text on it is on-accent.



sun-deep

#e39a12

Lip and pressed shade under sun fills.



tangerine

#ff8f33

Streak badge, highlights, second aircraft livery. Text on it is on-accent.



tangerine-deep

#d9641a

Lip and pressed shade under tangerine fills.



cherry

#ff5d52

Lives, destructive buttons, collision alerts. Text on it is on-accent.



cherry-deep

#c9302c

Lip and pressed shade under cherry fills.

Flight paths and liveries













path-1

= sun

Flight path and livery of the 1st aircraft on screen. Path colours are assigned in order and reused once an aircraft lands.

path-2

= tangerine

Flight path and livery, 2nd aircraft.

path-3

= cherry

Flight path and livery, 3rd aircraft.

path-4

#ff7ac8

Flight path and livery, 4th aircraft. Bubblegum.

path-5

#b48cff

Flight path and livery, 5th aircraft. Grape.

path-6

#4fe0e6

Flight path and livery, 6th aircraft. Lagoon.

Status

success

#35d6b0

Safe landing, valid landing zone glow, confirmations. A teal, not a green, so it reads on the lawn and stays apart from cherry for colour-blind players. Always paired with a check icon or a word. Text on it is on-accent.

success-ink

#0b6b59

Success text on surface and surface-raised.

danger

= cherry

Collision, miss, wrong landing zone. Always paired with a warning icon or a word.

danger-ink

#b3221f

Danger text on surface and surface-raised.

warning

= sun

Near-miss warning ring between two aircraft.

info

= sky-500

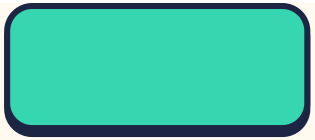
Neutral hints: next-aircraft arrow, tutorial pulses.



focus

#ffffff

Inner band of the two-tone focus ring: 3px focus, then 3px outline outside it. One of the two bands always holds 3:1 against whatever the ring lands on.



zone-ok

= success

Glow on a runway or helipad while the path end is a valid landing.



zone-no

= cherry

Glow on a landing zone of the wrong type for the selected aircraft.

Aircraft and sky objects



fuselage

#fdfcf5
night #f1f3fa

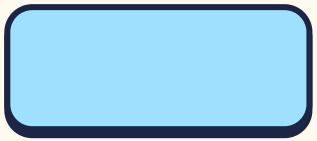
Aircraft body white.



fuselage-shade

#d5dbe8
night #b4bcd2

Engines, nacelles and the shaded side of the fuselage.



glass

#9fe0ff
night #8fd0ff

Cockpit windows. Keep them big.



glass-shine

#ffffff

The single highlight streak on a cockpit window.



prop-blur

rgba(29, 37, 69, 0.3)
night rgba(223, 230, 245, 0.3)

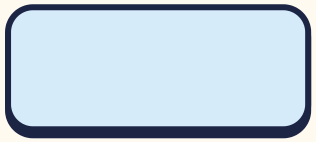
Translucent disc of a spinning rotor.



cloud

#ffffff
night #a9b5d6

Ambient drifting clouds above the field, drawn at opacity-cloud.



cloud-shade

#d6ebfa
night #7f8cb3

Underside of clouds.



shadow-ground

rgba(24, 40, 30, 0.28)
night rgba(4, 7, 18, 0.5)

The soft shadow an aircraft or cloud casts on the ground.



select-ring

#ffffff
night #ffe98a

Dashed ring around the selected aircraft. Always drawn over an outline-coloured casing, like the flight path.



star

#ffe066

Star burst on a safe landing; streak sparkles.



poof

#f7f8fc
night #dfe4f2

Comic poof cloud on a collision.



poof-shade

#c8d1e6
night #9aa5c4

Shaded lobes of the poof.



scrim

`rgba(17, 24, 58, 0.55)`
`night rgba(3, 5, 16, 0.7)`

Dims the field behind the pause and game-over dialogs.

FOUNDATIONS

Type

DynaPuff for headers, titles, buttons and the score. Inconsolata for regular text, labels and readouts.

Display · DynaPuff

Final Approach

display-xl · 72px/68px · 700 · -0.01em — The game title on the splash and main menu only.

Game over

display-lg · 48px/48px · 700 — Dialog headlines: Paused, Game over, Cleared to land.

Nice landing!

display-md · 36px/40px · 700 — Screen titles and the final score.

12 450

score · 32px/32px · 700 — The live score in the HUD and score popups. Thin space as thousands separator.

Titles · DynaPuff

Choose an airport

title-lg · 28px/32px · 600 — Section headings in menus.

Meadow Field

title-md · 22px/28px · 600 — Card titles, level names.

Sound effects

title-sm · 18px/24px · 600 — Settings rows, small headings.

Take off

button-label · 18px/20px · 600 — Labels of medium and large buttons.

Retry

button-label-sm · 15px/18px · 600 — Labels of small buttons, segments and chips.

Text · Inconsolata

Tap an aircraft, then drag to draw its path.

body-lg · 18px/28px · 500 — Tutorial copy and dialog lead text.

Planes land on runways. Helicopters land on helipads.

body · 16px/24px · 500 — All regular text. Never lighter than 500: thin strokes look weak beside the outlines.

Two aircraft got too close.

body-sm · 14px/20px · 500 — Supporting text in cards and toasts.

Best 18 200

caption · 12px/16px · 600 — Metadata under titles.

Readouts · Inconsolata

x3 STREAK

readout · 20px/24px · 800 — Numbers that change while you watch: streak multiplier, countdowns, stats.

NEXT UP

label · 13px/16px · 800 · 0.08em — Uppercase eyebrow labels above HUD values and settings groups. Write them in capitals.

FA 204

callsign · 12px/14px · 800 · 0.04em — The tag that follows a selected aircraft. Uppercase letters and digits.

FOUNDATIONS

Shape and depth

Spacing

TOKEN	VALUE	SCALE	USE
space-1	4px		Gap between an icon and its label; hearts in the lives meter.
space-2	8px		Inner padding of chips and HUD pills; gap between segments.
space-3	12px		Gap between HUD items; small button padding.
space-4	16px		HUD inset from the screen edge; card padding; default gap.
space-5	24px		Panel padding; gap between dialog buttons and copy.
space-6	32px		Dialog padding; gap between menu sections.
space-7	48px		Vertical rhythm on the main menu.
space-8	64px		Title block offset on splash and game over.

Radius

TOKEN	VALUE	CORNER	USE
`radius-sm`	8px		Chips, callsign tag, small tiles.
`radius-md`	14px		Buttons, icon buttons, HUD chips.
`radius-lg`	22px		Panels and level cards.
`radius-xl`	32px		Dialogs.
`radius-pill`	999px		Toggles, the streak badge, score popups, path dash caps.

Lines and flight path

TOKEN	VALUE	STROKE	USE
`line-1`	2px		Detail strokes inside a shape: window shine, runway dashes, grass tufts.
`line-2`	3px		Outline of small UI: chips, toggles, icons at 24px.
`line-3`	4px		The default outline: aircraft, buttons, panels, runways.

TOKEN	VALUE	STROKE	USE
line-4	6px		Outline of display type and of dialogs.
path-stroke	8px		Width of the coloured flight path dash.
path-casing	14px		Width of the outline-coloured casing drawn under the flight path.
path-dash	18px		Dash length of the flight path.
path-gap	16px		Gap between flight path dashes.
path-dot	22px		Diameter of the end dot of a flight path.

Shadows

TOKEN	VALUE	DEPTH	USE
shadow-lip-sm	0 3px 0 #1d2545		Hard lip under chips and small buttons. No blur: this is the toy-block edge.
shadow-lip	0 5px 0 #1d2545		Hard lip under buttons and HUD chips. Pressing a control collapses it to shadow-lip-sm and moves the control down by the difference.
shadow-lip-lg	0 8px 0 #1d2545		Hard lip under panels, cards and dialogs.
shadow-soft	0 10px 0 rgba(29, 37, 69, 0.16)		Second, translucent lip that grounds a dialog on the scrim.

TOKEN	VALUE	DEPTH	USE
shadow-float	6px 10px 6px rgba(24, 40, 30, 0.28)		The soft ground shadow of anything airborne: aircraft, clouds, score popups. Offset down-right, as if the sun sits top-left.
shadow-well	inset 0 3px 0 rgba(29, 37, 69, 0.14)		Inner top edge of sunken wells: toggle track, segmented trough.

Sizes

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
touch-min	48px	Minimum touch target for any control.
touch-aircraft	72px	Minimum pick diameter around an aircraft, however small it is drawn.
hud-chip	56px	Height of HUD chips and icon buttons in the HUD.
button-sm	40px	Height of small buttons (48px touch target with its margin).
button-md	52px	Height of default buttons.
button-lg	64px	Height of the main menu call to action.
icon-sm	20px	Icons inside chips and small buttons.
icon-md	28px	Icons inside buttons and HUD chips.
icon-lg	40px	Icons in coach marks and empty states.
sprite-light-prop	56px	Drawn size of the light prop at 1x viewport scale.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
sprite-helicopter	64px	Drawn size of the helicopter, rotor disc included.
sprite-turboprop	68px	Drawn size of the turboprop.
sprite-jet	72px	Drawn size of the jet.
sprite-jumbo	104px	Drawn size of the jumbo. Exaggerated on purpose.

Opacity

TOKEN	VALUE	SAMPLE	USE
opacity-disabled	0.45		Disabled controls and locked levels.
opacity-cloud	0.85		Ambient clouds, so aircraft stay readable beneath them.
opacity-path-idle	0.7		Paths of aircraft that are not selected.
opacity-ghost	0.5		The straight-on projection drawn past a path end.

Layers

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`z-field`	0	Lawn, runways, helipads, ground decoration.
`z-zone`	10	Landing zone glows.
`z-path`	20	Flight paths and end dots.
`z-ground-shadow`	30	Aircraft shadows, all below every aircraft.
`z-aircraft`	40	Aircraft, selection ring, callsign tag.
`z-fx`	50	Star bursts, poofs, score popups.
`z-clouds`	60	Ambient clouds.
`z-hud`	70	HUD and coach marks.
`z-overlay`	80	Scrim and dialogs.

FOUNDATIONS

Motion

Bouncy and short. Things arrive with one overshoot, controls snap, and the world never stops moving a little.

Easing

TOKEN	VALUE	FEEL	USE
`ease-bounce`	`cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)`		Anything arriving: pop-ins, dialog drop, selection ring. Overshoots once.
`ease-snap`	`cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.9, 0.3, 1)`		State changes of controls: press, toggle, segment slide.
`ease-out-soft`	`cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)`		Things leaving or fading: score popups rising, poof clearing.
`ease-sway`	`cubic-bezier(0.45, 0, 0.55, 1)`		Ambient back-and-forth: windsock, idle bob.

Duration

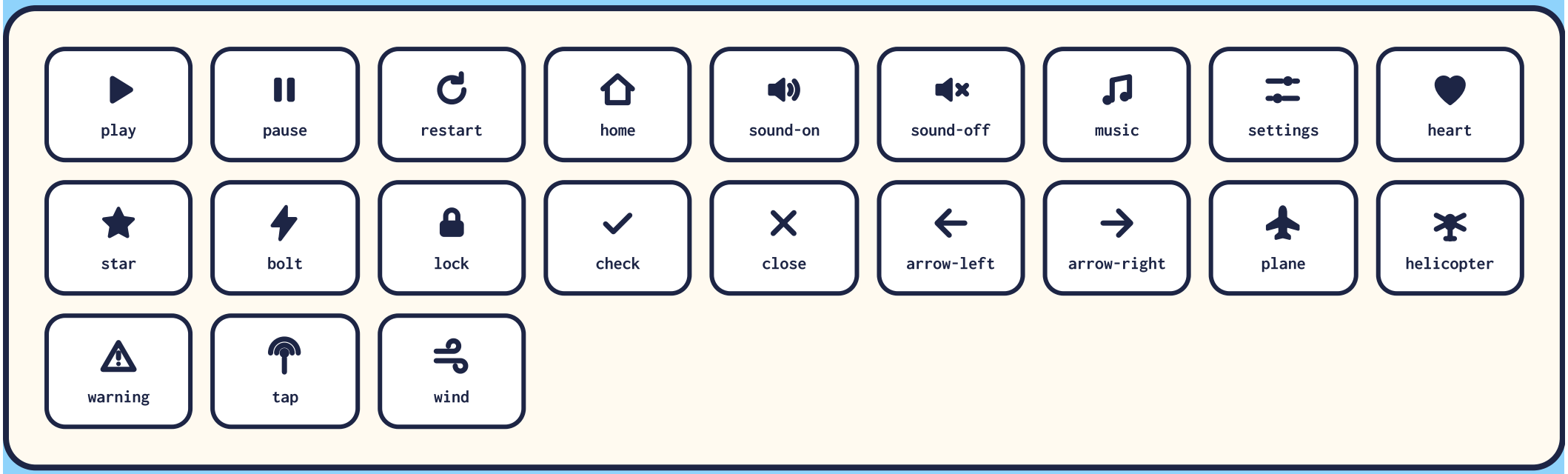
TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`dur-press`	`90ms`	Button press and release.
`dur-quick`	`160ms`	Toggles, segment changes, selection ring appearing.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
dur-pop	280ms	Pop-in of chips, popups and coach marks.
dur-land	420ms	Squash-and-stretch on touchdown before the aircraft disappears.
dur-burst	600ms	Star burst and comic poof.
dur-dialog	360ms	Dialog drop-in.
dur-rotor	240ms	One rotor or propeller revolution. Linear, endless.
dur-march	900ms	One dash-length of flight path marching towards the end dot.
dur-sway	2400ms	One windsock wave.
dur-drift	48s	A cloud crossing the viewport.

ASSETS

Icons

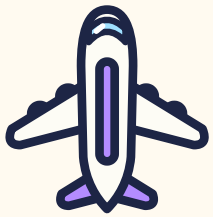
21 glyphs on a 24px grid with 3px round strokes. They take the text colour.



ASSETS

Aircraft

Five flying toys on a 96-unit square. Drawn size grows with how hard each is to handle.

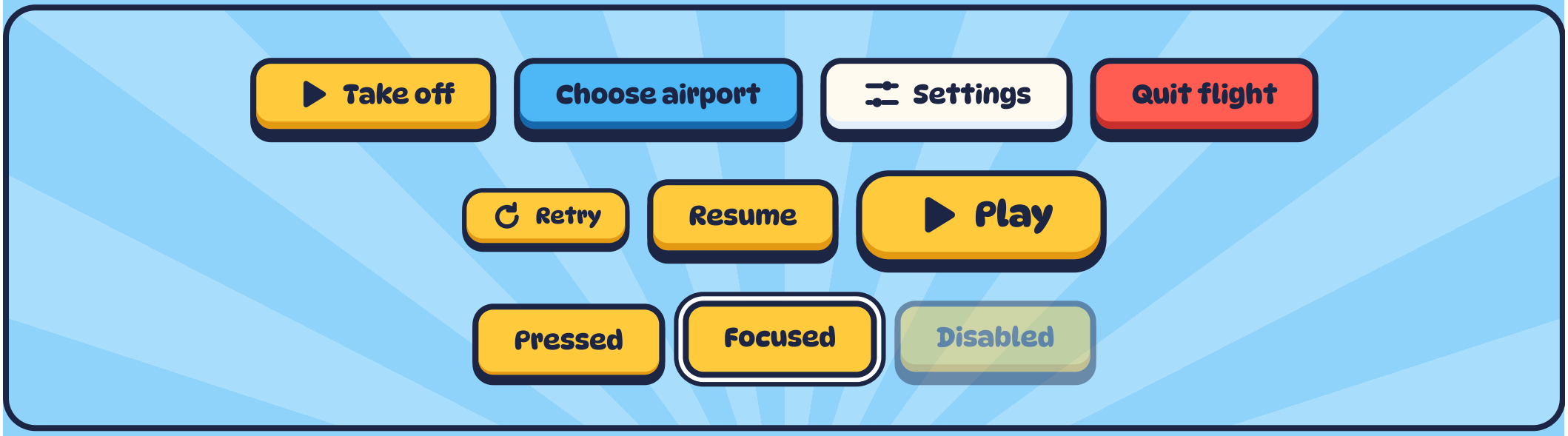
SPRITE	TYPE	SPEED	TURN RATE	LANDS ON	DRAWN SIZE
	**Light prop**	Slow	High	Runway	**56px**
	**Turboprop**	Medium	Medium	Runway	**68px**
	**Jet**	Fast	Low	Runway	**72px**
	**Jumbo**	Medium-fast	Very low	Runway	**104px**
	**Helicopter**	Slow	Very high	Helipad	**64px**

Components

Actions

Button

The chunky toy-block button for every text action in menus and dialogs.



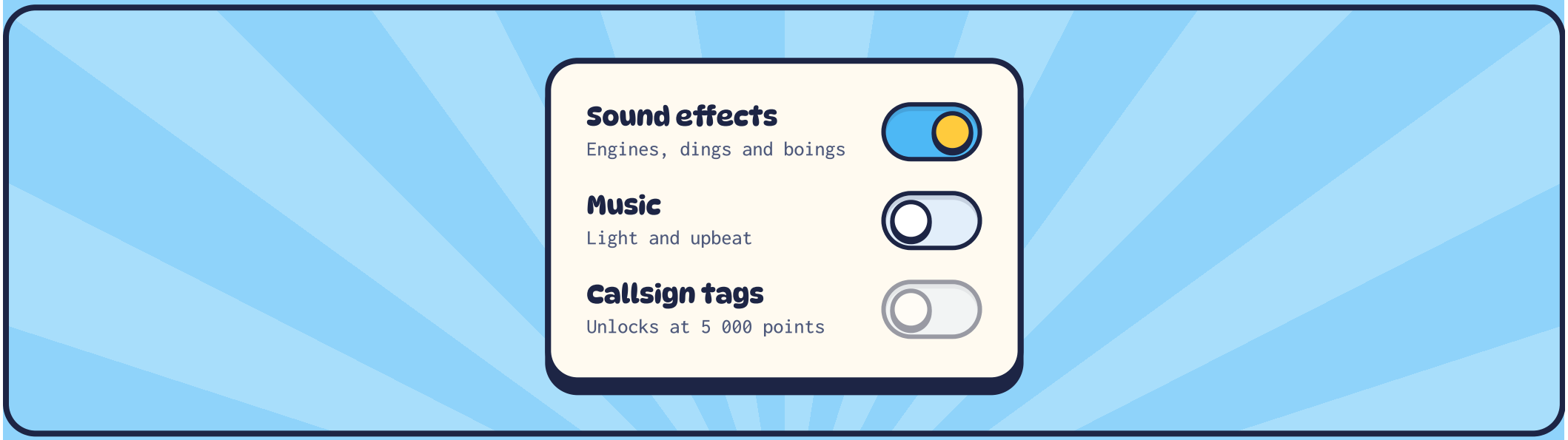
Icon Button

A square button that carries one icon and no text, used in the HUD and for close and back.



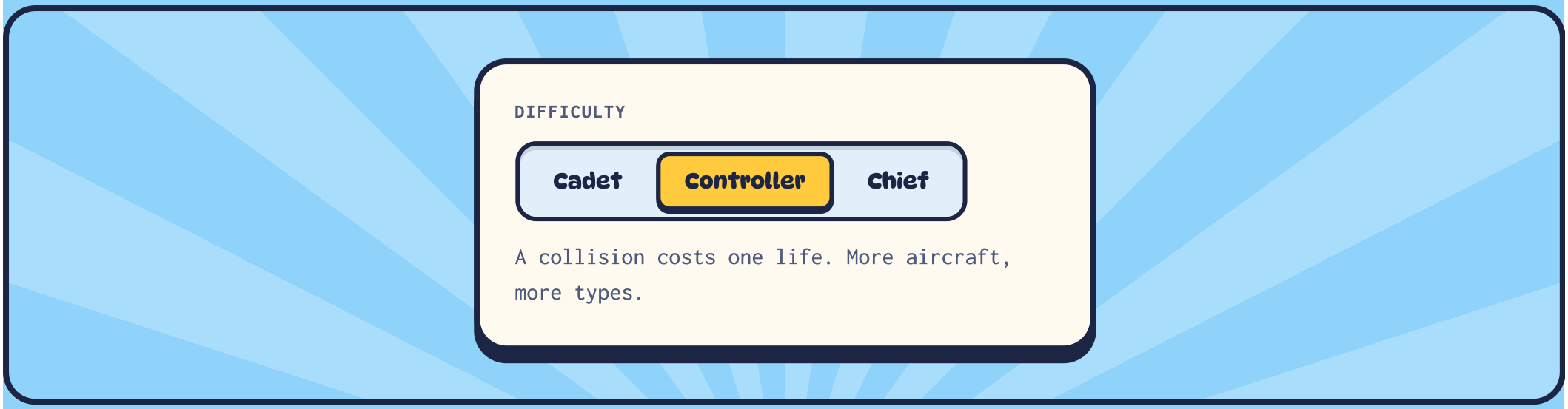
Toggle

An on/off switch for settings that apply immediately.



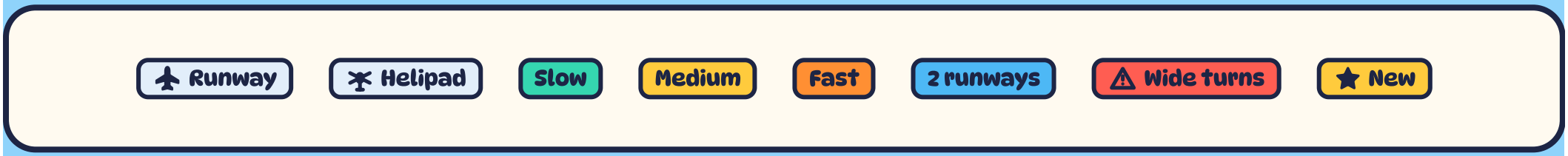
Segmented Control

A row of two to four mutually exclusive choices, one always selected.



Chip

A small outlined tag that names a property: aircraft type, speed class, landing zone, lock state.



HUD

Hud Bar

The gameplay overlay: score and streak on the left, next aircraft, lives and pause on the right.



Score Counter

The live score in a HUD chip.



Lives Meter

Remaining lives as a row of hearts.



Next Aircraft Hint

A HUD chip that previews the next aircraft and the edge it will enter from.



Streak Badge

A tilted pill that shows the current landing streak multiplier.



Score Popup

A short-lived pill that rises from the place something happened on the field.



World

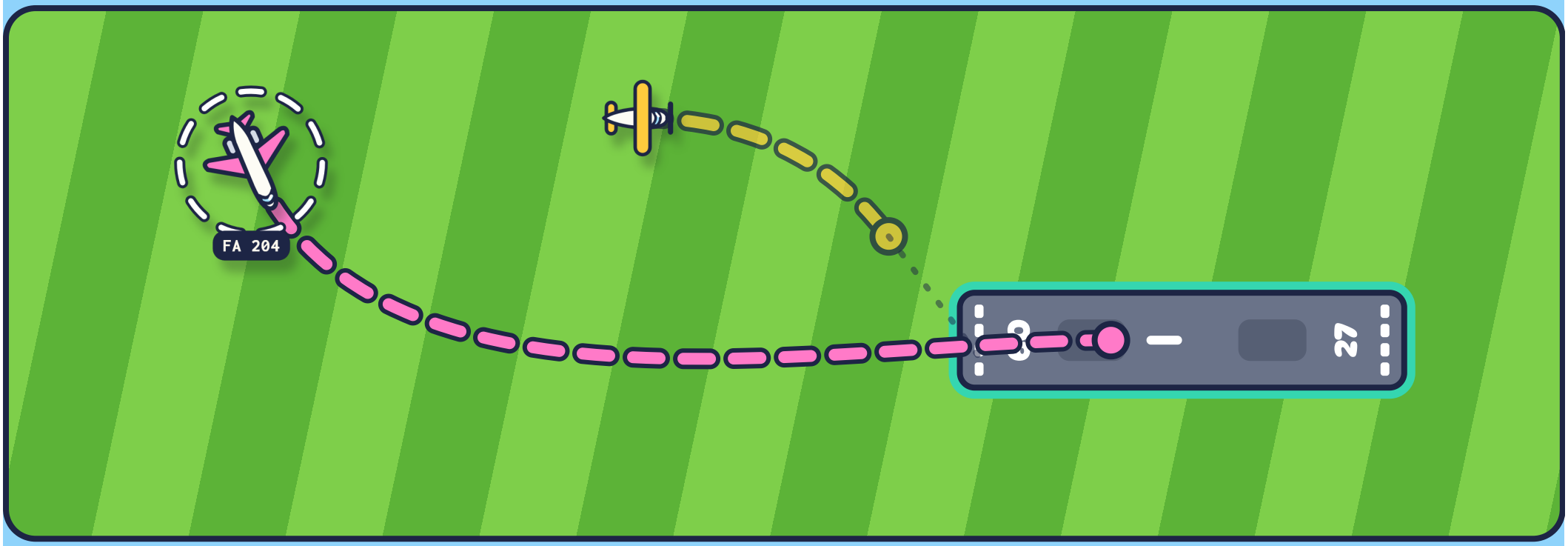
Aircraft

The five flying toys, drawn top-down with the nose pointing up at heading 0.



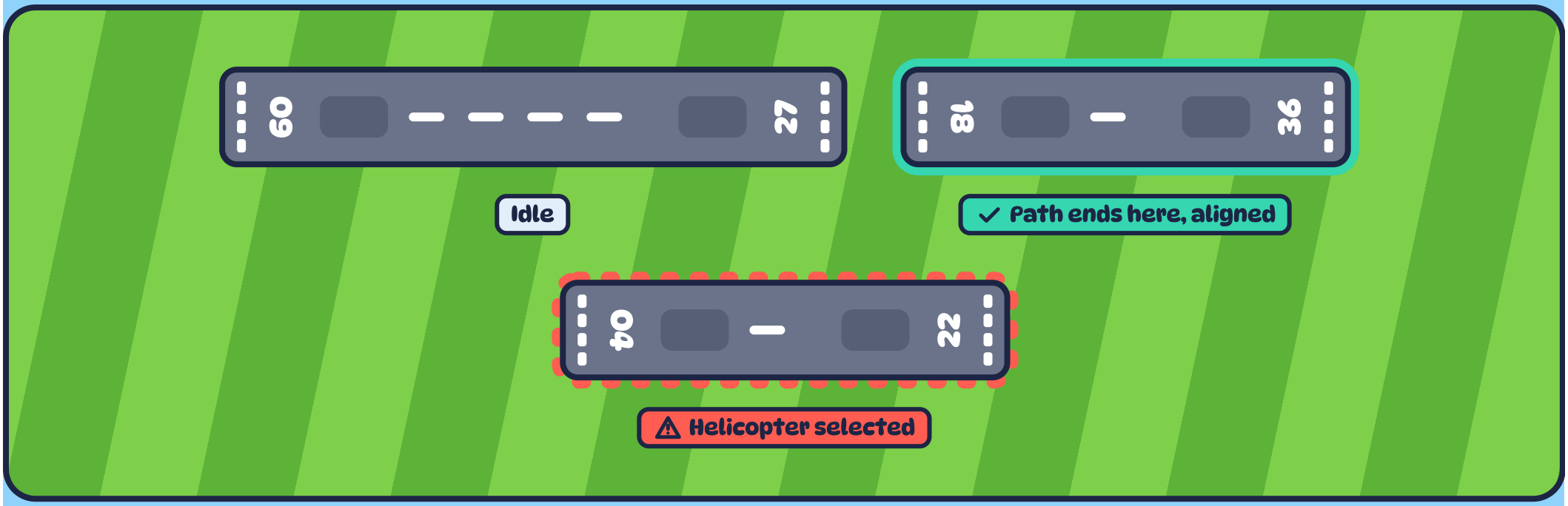
Flight Path

The dashed line a player draws from an aircraft to where it should go.



Runway

A landing strip for airplanes, defined by position, heading, length and its two numbers.



Helipad

A round landing spot for helicopters.



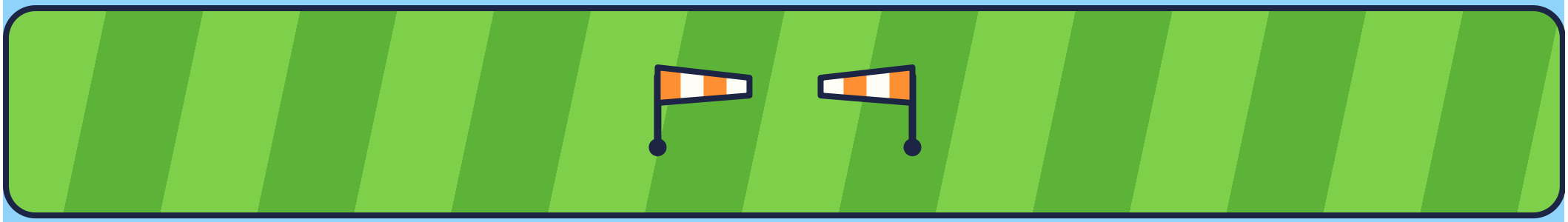
Cloud

An ambient cloud that drifts across the field above the aircraft.



Windsock

A striped windsock beside the runway, waving.



Effects

The three feedback animations that tell the player what just happened.



Menus

Panel

A paper-light container for grouped content in menus.

How to play



Tap an aircraft to select it.



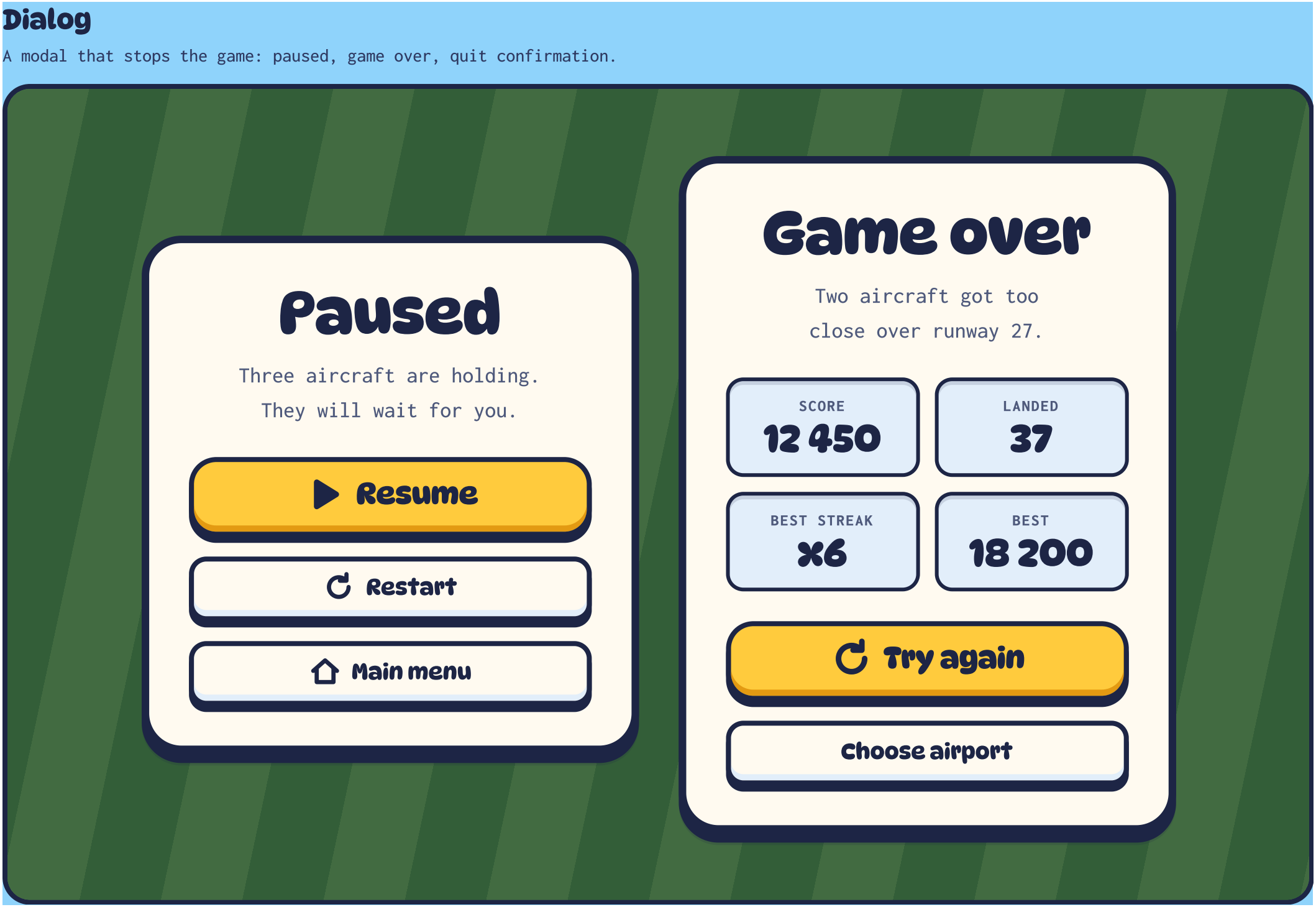
Drag to a runway. Planes need to line up with it.



Helicopters land on the H.

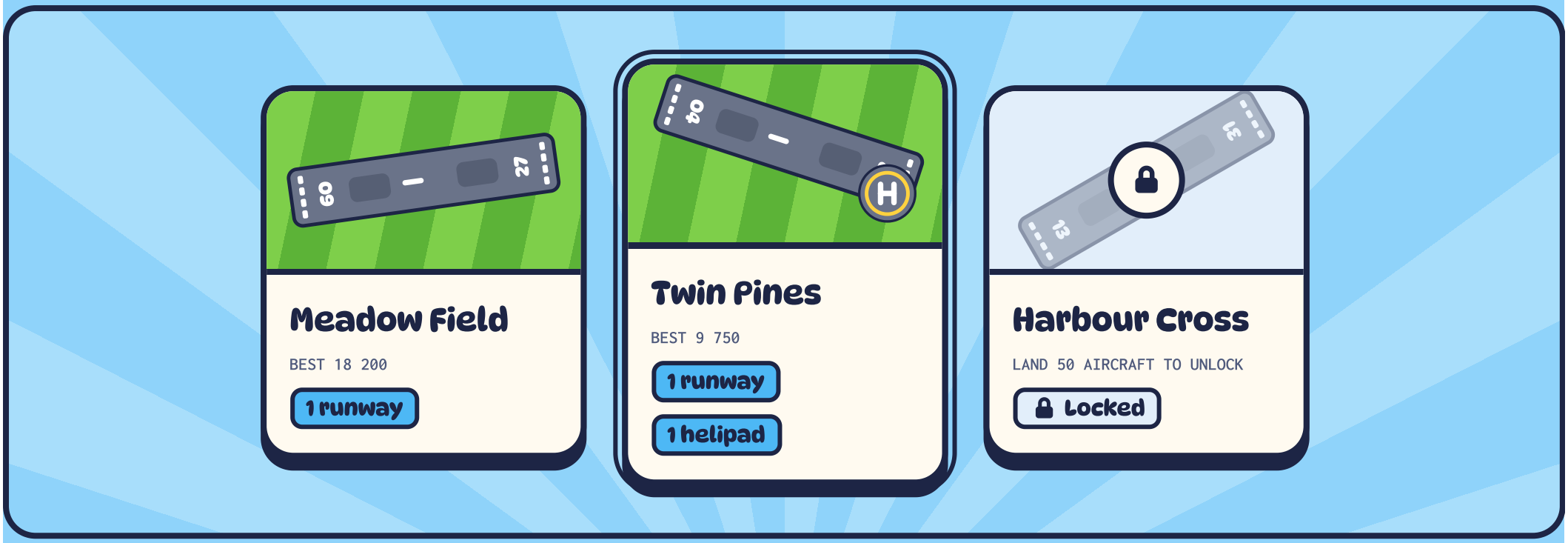
Dialog

A modal that stops the game: paused, game over, quit confirmation.



Level Card

A selectable card for one airport layout.



Coach Mark

A dark speech bubble that teaches one gesture at a time.



Wordmark

The game's name set in DynaPuff, outlined and tilted.



REFERENCE COMPOSITIONS

Screens

Game Screen

A reference composition of a game in progress, showing how every world and HUD piece layers.



Main Menu

A reference composition of the main menu on the sky backdrop.



THEME

Night

Night darkens the sky and moonlights the field. Panels, chips and aircraft stay paper-light and accent fills stay bright, so outlines and labels hold.

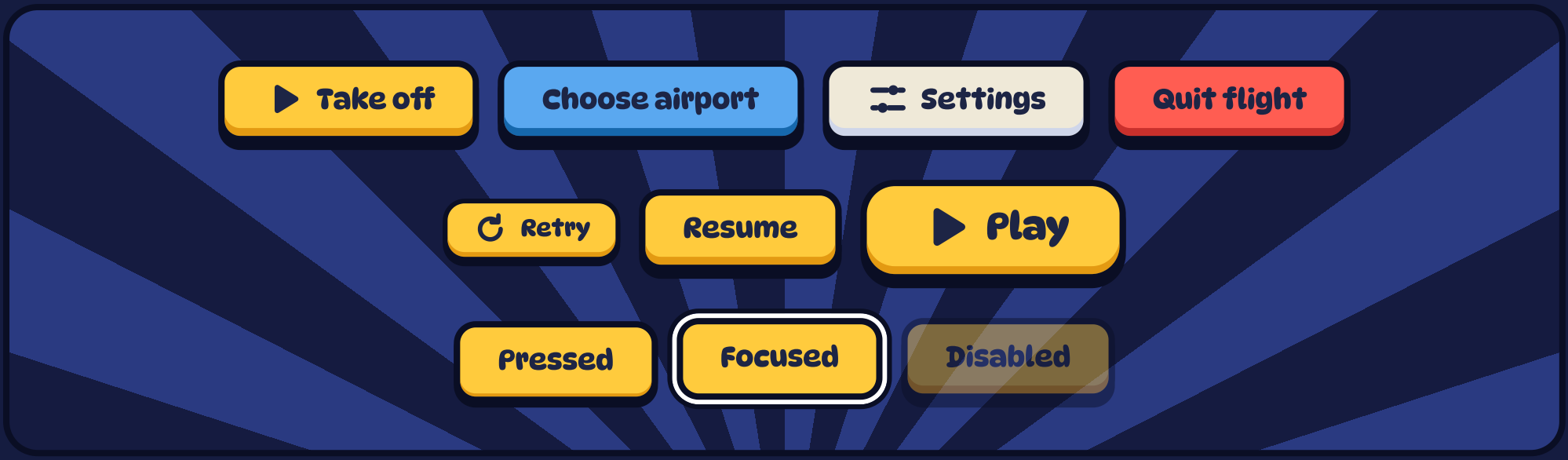
Hud Bar

The gameplay overlay: score and streak on the left, next aircraft, lives and pause on the right.



Button

The chunky toy-block button for every text action in menus and dialogs.



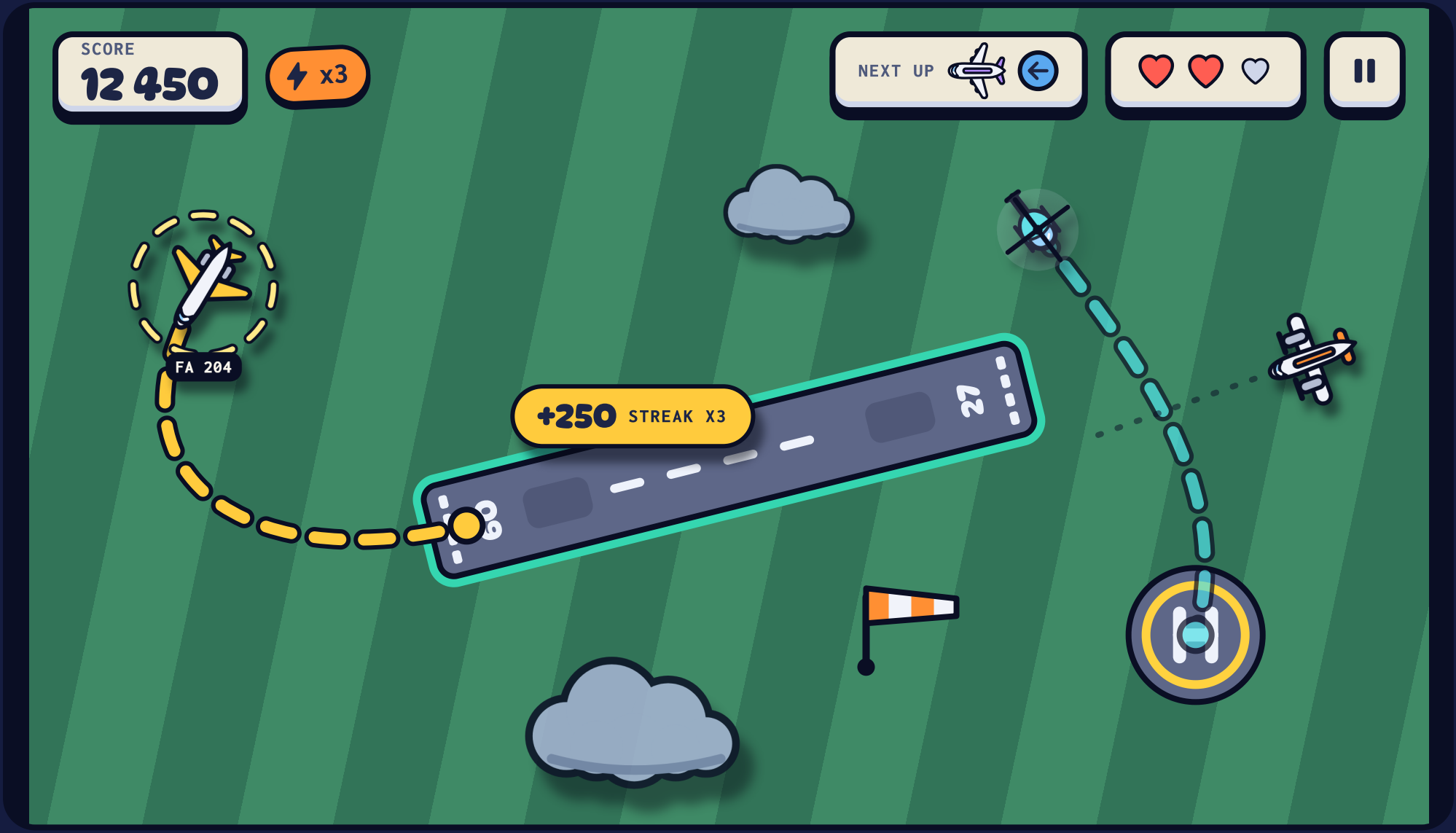
Aircraft

The five flying toys, drawn top-down with the nose pointing up at heading 0.



Game Screen

A reference composition of a game in progress, showing how every world and HUD piece layers.



CONTENT

Voice

A friendly tower controller: short, calm, specific. Sentence case, verbs on buttons, no blame, no emoji.

- ✓ Two aircraft got too close over runway 27.
- ✗ ~~Oops! You crashed!!~~
- ✓ Try again
- ✗ ~~OK~~
- ✓ Missed
- ✗ ~~You failed to land the plane~~
- ✓ Tap an aircraft, then drag to draw its path.
- ✗ ~~Utilise touch input to define a trajectory.~~